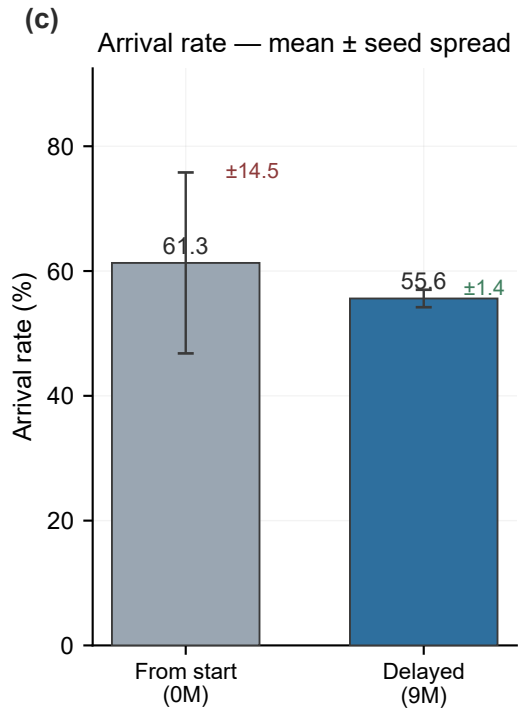
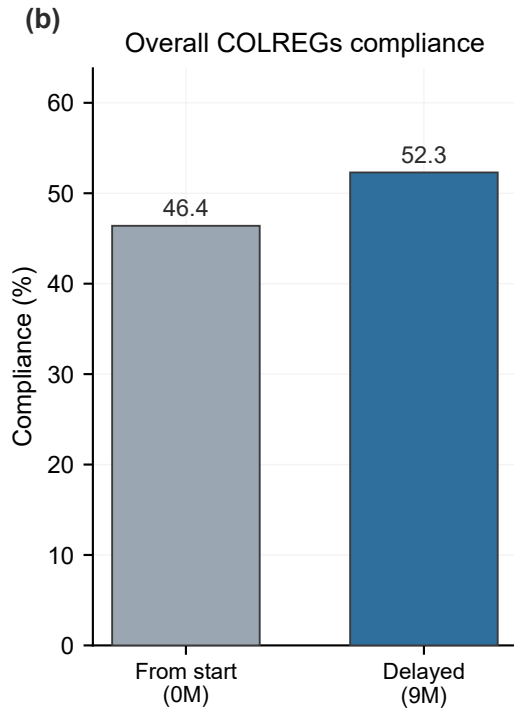
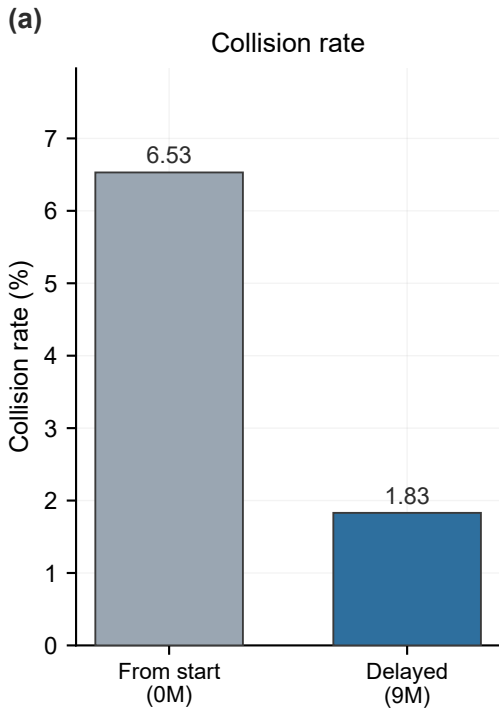




Both arms train for the full 16M decisions; the only difference is when messages start flowing. Delayed wins collision and compliance on all three seeds. Arrival mean favours from-start, but its seed spread is ten times larger — one seed converged to a rushing policy (timeout 15.6%, collisions x3.7). Establishing a stable local control policy before coupling agents through learned communication produces a safer, far less seed-sensitive solution.